OTT ▸

Making the Right Choices

With a string of nuanced performances—including a major role in Riz Ahmed's comedy series *Bait*—actor Sheeba Chaddha is embracing her most defining phase yet



How does a mother handle the news that her son, a Pakistani-Brit actor based in London, is being considered to play the next James Bond? It's one of the many scenarios Sheeba Chaddha's character Tahirah deals with in the Amazon Prime comedy series, *Bait*, created by and starring Oscar-winning filmmaker Riz Ahmed. In addition, there's Tahirah's rivalry with a snarky relative (Soni Razdan) and her need to "carefully guard" the big development. "The idea of *nazar naa lag jaaye* is very prominent in South Asian culture," says Chaddha. "The show's relatable in that the mother is someone who wants the best for the child. There's a fine line between being supportive and overbearing."

Bait continues Chaddha's hot streak over the past few years, which has included supporting parts in films like *Badhaai Do*, *Haq* and *The Great Shamsuddin Family*. She acknowledges the spike in not just opportunity but also attention coming her way. "When you do that kind of work, there is joy because you are working with people who have put in the effort, thought and nuance in creating the character and the world," says Chaddha. The actor attributes this lush patch in her career to both the growing clout of streaming as well as the "expansion in writing". "When we are equipped and have the backdrop of robust writing, an actor can bring something to the table," she adds.

THE LISTICLE

Upcoming Indian releases, theatrical and OTT, to watch out for



▼ **MAY 1** | *Theatres*

Raja Shivaji

Riteish Deshmukh stars in, and directs, this historical, to be released in multiple languages. Sanjay Dutt plays Shivaji's nemesis, Afzal Khan. The supporting cast includes Abhishek Bachchan, Genelia Deshmukh and Vidya Balan. Expect blood and a boisterous background score.

▼ **APRIL 3** | *Prime Video*

Maa Ka Sum

Math wizard son sets about inventing an algorithm to fish out the perfect partner for his single mother to go on a date with. Love is not an equation, but it'll take a few episodes to reach that conclusion. New series starring Mihir Ahuja and Mona Singh.

